



PROVEN

Turning Potential into Proof

Idea Profile

Problem Being Solved

Many South African SMEs receive funding, but there is often a visibility and support gap after the money is disbursed. Between reporting periods, problems such as declining revenue, rising expenses, cash-flow pressure or missed milestones can go unnoticed until they become difficult to address.

This affects both sides of the funding relationship. Entrepreneurs may not have timely insight or guidance to correct problems, while funders may lack a clear, continuous view of how funded businesses are progressing and whether their support is producing sustainable results.

Target Market

Proven initially targets organisations that fund, support or manage portfolios of South African SMEs. This includes banks with entrepreneurship and enterprise-development programmes, government and public-sector SME support organisations, development-finance institutions, incubators, accelerators and other SME funding programmes.

The entrepreneurs are the end users who benefit from the platform, while funders and SME-support organisations are the primary customers.

Innovation

Proven is a post-funding FinTech and business intelligence platform built around both sides of the funding relationship. It creates a shared evidence layer through four connected functions:

TRACK	DETECT	GUIDE	PROVE
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Proven tracks key business-performance indicators, detects meaningful changes and early signs of risk, provides practical guidance on what to address next, and builds an ongoing performance history from the business's reported performance.

The innovation is not a completely new technology. It is the way these capabilities are combined into one transparent system where entrepreneurs and funders work from the same evidence.

Entrepreneurs can see how their business is performing, understand what needs attention and receive guidance on what to improve. Funders can see portfolio-level performance, understand the reasons behind changes and identify where support or review may be needed.

Expected Impact

Proven aims to help funded SMEs identify problems earlier, take corrective action sooner and build stronger, more credible performance histories.

For funders, Proven aims to improve visibility across funded portfolios, identify businesses that may need attention and provide better evidence of how funding is translating into business progress.

Over time, consistent business performance can help an SME build a credit-readiness profile based on its documented performance history. Proven does not approve or reject credit; instead, it helps businesses build evidence that can strengthen their case when approaching financial institutions or other sources of future funding.

Ultimately, Proven aims to create a stronger SME funding ecosystem where capital is followed by visibility, guidance and evidence, helping viable businesses improve, sustain growth and build a clearer path toward future opportunities.